

Standard Operating Procedure

IV Line and Tubing Safety — Preventing Misconnection

«Hospital Name» — Supports MOM.7.h (CORE, Stop-Work)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» prevents a fatal tubing misconnection — the wrong-route delivery of a medication, feed, or fluid caused by connecting the wrong line.

2. Scope

Applies to every patient with more than one line or tube in place — IV, epidural, enteral feeding, drain, or central line.

3. Responsibility

Registered Nurse / Doctor: traces every line before connecting or reconnecting anything to it.

4. Procedure

1. Trace a line from the patient to its origin before every connection or reconnection — never assume a line's identity from its location or appearance alone.
2. Position dissimilar tubes away from each other wherever the patient has more than one type of line — physical separation reduces the chance of grabbing the wrong one.
3. Where the hospital's equipment includes ENFit or other ISO 80369-series application-specific connectors, use them as intended — never force an adapter to bridge two systems that are not meant to connect.
4. Label each line at the patient end where multiple lines are present, to support quick, accurate tracing during handover or an emergency.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not use an IV extension tube for an epidural, irrigation line, drain, central line, or enteric feeding tube — this substitution is prohibited absolutely, with no exception.

Do not connect or reconnect any line without tracing it first, from the patient to its origin.

Any staff member who sees an improper connection stops the connection immediately and corrects it — this is never a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Record 8 of the MOM.7 Required Records pack: IV Line Trace & Tubing Safety Log.

7. Related Documents

- Policy on Safe Administration of Medications (HCO/MOM/POL/07) — MOM.7 policy

8. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any tubing-misconnection near miss or event.

9. References

- Global Enteral Device Supplier Association (GEDSA). (n.d.). ISO 80369 Series — Small-Bore Connectors for Liquids and Gases in Healthcare Applications. <https://stayconnected.org/enfit/> — the international standard behind application-specific connectors (including ENFit for enteral use) designed to make cross-system misconnection mechanically difficult.